

THEFAB COOKBOOK - VOLUME I

Red Bean and Onion Indian Pot

Fresh red beans soaked for 24 hours, onions cooked down slowly, fresh tomatoes and a layered curry base: some soft, some spicy, some masala. A deep, slow pot with warmth and rhythm.

Serves 6	Soak 24 h	Cook 2-2.5 h	Style Slow / spicy / vegetarian
-------------	--------------	-----------------	------------------------------------

TheFAB studio note

The flavour comes from contrast: soft curry for depth, hot curry for lift, masala for perfume. The onions must almost melt into the sauce.

Ingredients

- 500 g fresh red beans, soaked in cold water for 24 hours
- 4 large onions, thinly sliced
- 4 fresh ripe tomatoes, chopped
- 2 tbsp tomato paste
- 4 garlic cloves, grated
- 4 cm fresh ginger, grated
- 2 green chillies, split, optional
- 2 tsp mild curry powder
- 1 tsp hot curry powder
- 2 tsp garam masala or masala curry
- 1 tsp cumin seeds
- 1 tsp turmeric
- 1 tsp ground coriander
- 1 tsp smoked or sweet paprika
- 2 tbsp ghee or neutral oil
- Salt, black pepper, lemon juice and fresh coriander
- Water or light vegetable/chicken broth as needed

Method

- 1 Drain the soaked beans. Cover with fresh water, bring to a boil for 10 minutes, then lower the heat and simmer until tender. This can take 60 to 90 minutes depending on the beans.
- 2 In a large pot, cook the onions in ghee or oil with a pinch of salt until golden and sweet, about 25 minutes.
- 3 Add garlic, ginger, chillies and cumin seeds. Cook until fragrant, then add the curry powders, turmeric, coriander, paprika and tomato paste.
- 4 Add the fresh tomatoes and cook them down until they become a thick sauce. Add a splash of broth if the spices catch.
- 5 Add the cooked beans and enough cooking liquid to make a generous stew. Simmer slowly for 45 to 60 minutes so the beans absorb the curry.
- 6 Finish with garam masala, lemon juice, black pepper and fresh coriander. Serve with rice, naan or simply with yoghurt on top.

Proposed wine pairing

A pairing designed to support the main character of the dish rather than overpower it.

Best match	Off-dry Riesling, ideally Kabinett or Spatlese style.
Also works	Gewurztraminer for aromatic spice, Pinot Gris from Alsace, or a lightly chilled Grenache/GSM if you really want red wine.
Why it works	A touch of sweetness, low tannin and bright acidity calm chilli heat and lift ginger, tomato and masala aromatics.
Serving note	Serve whites well chilled. Avoid high-tannin reds: curry spice can make them feel harsh and metallic.

Personal adjustment: choose a bottle you would happily drink even without the dish. Pairing should amplify pleasure, not become an exam.